

Homework #1: Self-Monitoring Log

Observing My Patterns This Week

Name: _____ Week of: _____

What Is This Homework?

This week, your ONLY task is to OBSERVE and RECORD. You are NOT being asked to change anything yet. Think of yourself as a scientist studying your own patterns. Your job is to notice and write down what happens, without judging yourself.

Why am I doing this?

1. It builds YOUR awareness of the obsession-compulsion connection
2. It gives us the information we need to build YOUR personalized treatment plan
3. Many patients report that just NOTICING the cycle starts to weaken it

TIP: Try to fill this out as CLOSE to the event as possible (within an hour is ideal). If you wait until end of day, you may forget important details. Keep this worksheet with you or use your phone to take quick notes, then transfer them here.

How to Fill Out Each Column

Column 1: TRIGGER / SITUATION

What was happening when the thought appeared? Where were you? What were you doing?

Example: 'I was leaving the house for work' or 'I was holding a knife while cooking'

Column 2: INTRUSIVE THOUGHT / OBSESSION

What was the thought, image, or urge? Write it as specifically as you can.

Example: 'What if I didn't lock the door and someone breaks in?' or 'What if I hurt my child?'

Column 3: ANXIETY LEVEL (0-100)

How distressed did you feel? 0 = completely calm, 100 = worst anxiety imaginable

Use the scale: 0-20 mild | 21-40 moderate | 41-60 strong | 61-80 severe | 81-100 extreme

Column 4: COMPULSION PERFORMED

What did you DO in response? Include both visible actions AND mental actions. Also include avoidance (what you DIDN'T do because of the thought).

Example: 'Went back and checked the lock 4 times' or 'Mentally reviewed the last hour to make sure I didn't do anything bad'

Column 5: RELIEF DURATION

How long did the relief last after the compulsion? Minutes? Hours? Did it come back?

Column 6: ANXIETY IF RESISTED (if applicable)

If you tried NOT doing the compulsion, what was your anxiety level? How long did it last?

Self-Monitoring Log - Day 1

Date: _____

Day: _____

Trigger/Situation	Intrusive Thought	Anxiety(0-100)	Compulsion Performed	Relief Duration	If Resisted

End-of-day reflection:

Total number of episodes today: _____

Worst moment of the day: _____

Did I notice any patterns? _____

Self-Monitoring Log - Day 2

Date: _____

Day: _____

Trigger/Situation	Intrusive Thought	Anxiety(0-100)	Compulsion Performed	Relief Duration	If Resisted

End-of-day reflection:

Total number of episodes today: _____

Worst moment of the day: _____

Did I notice any patterns? _____

Self-Monitoring Log - Day 3

Date: _____

Day: _____

Trigger/Situation	Intrusive Thought	Anxiety(0-100)	Compulsion Performed	Relief Duration	If Resisted

End-of-day reflection:

Total number of episodes today: _____

Worst moment of the day: _____

Did I notice any patterns? _____

Self-Monitoring Log - Day 4

Date: _____

Day: _____

Trigger/Situation	Intrusive Thought	Anxiety(0-100)	Compulsion Performed	Relief Duration	If Resisted

End-of-day reflection:

Total number of episodes today: _____

Worst moment of the day: _____

Did I notice any patterns? _____

Self-Monitoring Log - Day 5

Date: _____

Day: _____

Trigger/Situation	Intrusive Thought	Anxiety(0-100)	Compulsion Performed	Relief Duration	If Resisted

End-of-day reflection:

Total number of episodes today: _____

Worst moment of the day: _____

Did I notice any patterns? _____

Self-Monitoring Log - Day 6

Date: _____

Day: _____

Trigger/Situation	Intrusive Thought	Anxiety(0-100)	Compulsion Performed	Relief Duration	If Resisted

End-of-day reflection:

Total number of episodes today: _____

Worst moment of the day: _____

Did I notice any patterns? _____

Self-Monitoring Log - Day 7

Date: _____

Day: _____

Trigger/Situation	Intrusive Thought	Anxiety(0-100)	Compulsion Performed	Relief Duration	If Resisted

End-of-day reflection:

Total number of episodes today: _____

Worst moment of the day: _____

Did I notice any patterns? _____

Weekly Summary & Patterns

At the end of the week, look back at all your entries and answer the following questions. This will help you and your therapist build your treatment plan.

1. My most common triggers were:

2. My most common intrusive thoughts were about:

3. My most common compulsions were:

4. The situations that caused the MOST anxiety (highest numbers):

5. The situations that caused the LEAST anxiety (lowest numbers):

6. Approximately how much TIME per day did my patterns take?

7. Did I notice any MENTAL compulsions I wasn't aware of before?

8. Was there any time I resisted a compulsion? What happened?

BRING THIS COMPLETED LOG TO YOUR NEXT SESSION. We will use it together to build your personalized step-by-step plan for getting better. The more honest and detailed you are, the better we can tailor the plan to YOUR specific situation.